

Nnn: This Feature-Rich Terminal File Manager will Enhance Your Productivity



Nnn is an open source terminal file manager written in C with productivity in mind. It offers numerous features, has very few library dependencies and the binary size is just around 60KB! Besides, the dependency on third-party utilities is minimal and anyway, the most required ones are installed by default on most systems.

Nnn is not just a file manager, but can perform disk usage analysis, batch rename files, work as an app launcher and pick files. The plugin framework extends the capabilities of the core file manager. There are 30+ plugins available. These include a (Neo) Vim plugin, as well as plugins to view thumbnails of images, watch videos, preview images, find duplicates, view and upload files, play music, create ringtones, and so on. You can also add your own plugins.

One of the important goals of the project is to support low-power devices. In addition to Linux, macOS

(via Homebrew), BSD, Cygwin and the Linux subsystem for Windows, nnn also runs smoothly on the Raspberry Pi and the Termux environment for Android.

Note that in this article, we are using the development snapshot of nnn available at the time of writing. However, nnn is available on many package managers and distros like Arch Linux, Debian, Fedora, Homebrew, openSUSE and Ubuntu (and others in this family). If it's not readily available for you or if the packaged version is old, you can compile it from source code easily. For example, on Ubuntu 18.04, the following commands will compile and install nnn:

```
$ sudo apt-get install pkg-config  
libncursesw5-dev libreadline-dev  
$ make  
$ sudo make strip install
```

You may want to install some optional utilities like *bsdtar* and *trash-cli* depending on your regular workflows.

To install plugins, run the following command:

```
$ curl -Ls https://raw.githubusercontent.com/jarun/nnn/master/  
plugins/getplugins | sh
```

There's more information on the